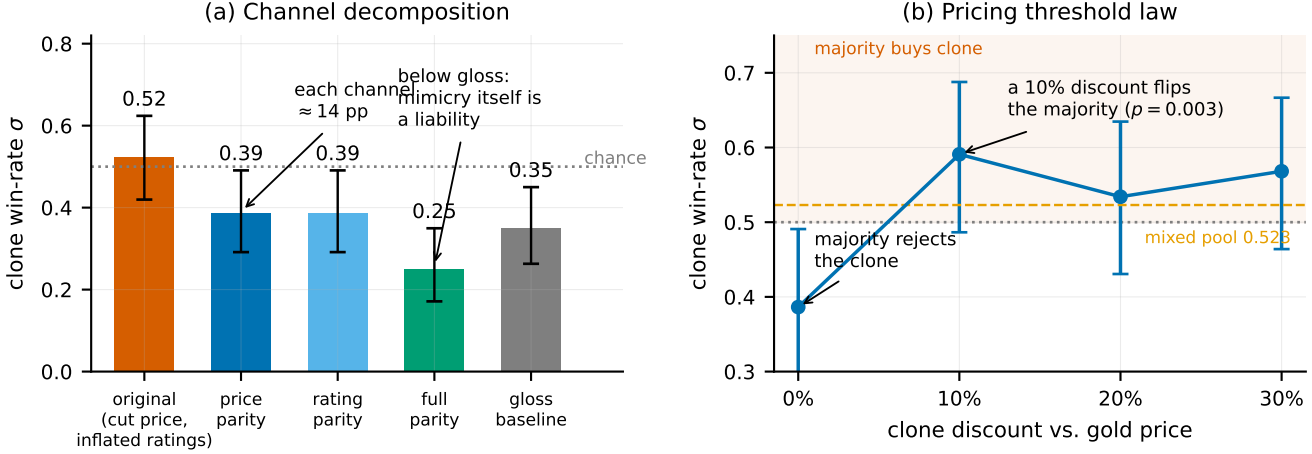
(a) Channel decomposition
clone win-rate σ
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
0.52
0.39
0.39
0.25
0.35
each channel ≈ 14 pp
below gloss: mimicry itself is a liability
chance
original (cut price, inflated ratings)
price parity
rating parity
full parity
gloss baseline
(b) Pricing threshold law
majority buys clone
a 10% discount flips the majority (p = 0.003)
majority rejects the clone
mixed pool 0.523
clone win-rate σ
0.7
0.6
0.5
0.4
0.3
0%
10%
20%
30%
clone discount vs. gold price